SETUP GUIDE · MAC

Setting up *The Assistant*

Five short steps, about fifteen minutes, and you only do it once.
Every step is one thing to click. Go in order and don't skip ahead.

BEFORE YOU START, YOU NEED

one

A Mac

Any recent Mac. A Windows guide comes later.

two

A Claude plan, Pro or higher

The Assistant runs on your own Claude account. The free plan doesn't include the part of Claude it lives in.

three

An external hard drive

Where your shoots are kept. If your photos live on your computer for now, it still works, and the Assistant will talk to you about it once.

four

The Assistant file

One file called **The-Assistant.zip**, from us. Save it to your Downloads folder. **Don't open it** or unzip it.

The five steps

1. Install Claude on your Mac
2. Make a folder for the Assistant
3. Add the Assistant to Claude
4. Let it work while you're away
5. Say hi

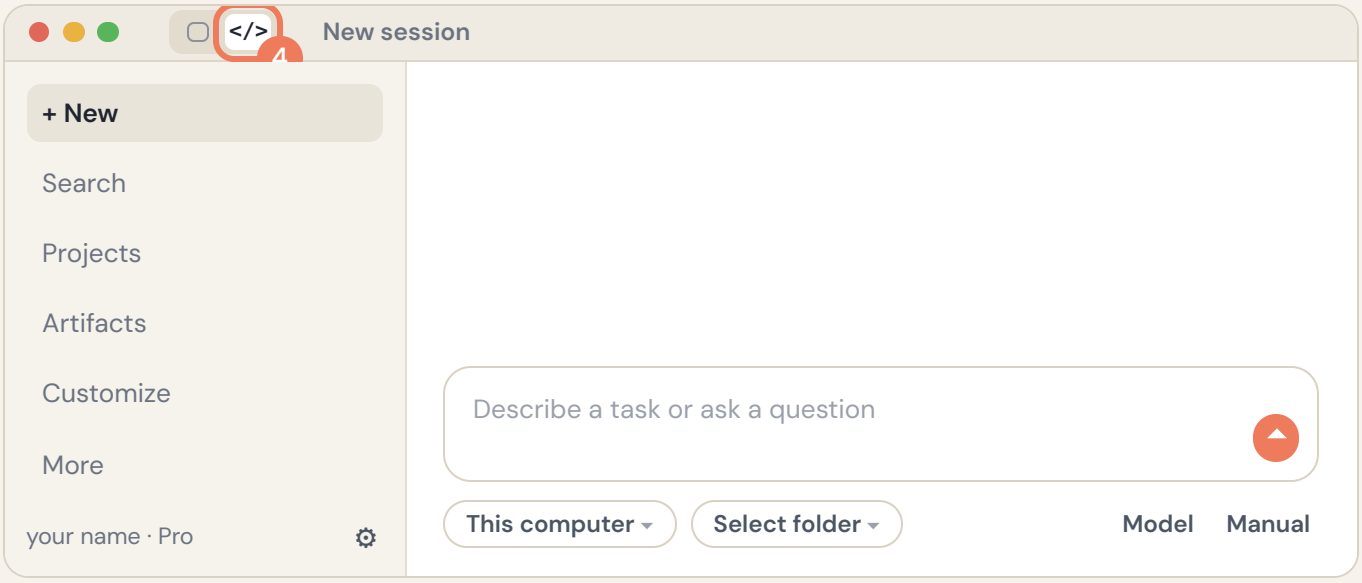
Every step here was walked through on a real Mac on November 5, 2026. The pictures are drawings of those screens, so yours may look a little different. The words to click are the same.

STEP 1 OF 5 · ABOUT 3 MINUTES

1 Install Claude on your Mac

Claude is the app the Assistant lives inside. If Claude is already on your Mac and you're signed in, skip to number 4.

1. Open Safari and go to **claude.ai/download**.
2. Click the download for **Mac**. When it finishes, open the downloaded file and drag **Claude** into your **Applications** folder.
3. Open **Claude** from Applications and **sign in** with your Claude account.
4. At the top of the left column there are two small pictures side by side. Click the one that looks like `</>`. That one is **Code**.



Drawing. The </> picture is at the top of the left column.

You'll know it worked when the top of the window says **New session** and there's a message box at the bottom with a row of small choices under it.

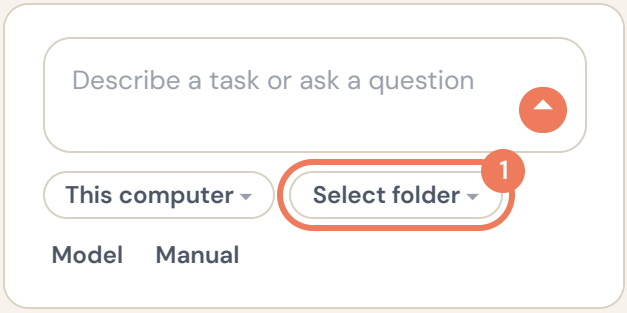
If it asks you to upgrade: your Claude plan doesn't include Code yet. You need Pro or higher. **If it asks you to sign in online:** follow the link, then come back to the app.

STEP 2 OF 5 · ABOUT 1 MINUTE

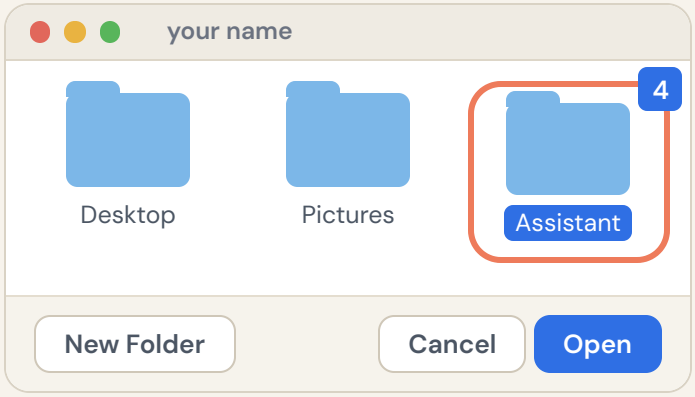
2 Make a folder for the Assistant

The Assistant needs one small folder of its own to keep its notes in. **Your photos never go in this folder.**

1. Under the message box, click the choice with a small **folder** picture on it.
2. Click **Open folder…** A window opens showing your files.
3. Press Command + Shift + H. That jumps to your **home folder**, the one with your name on it.
4. Click **New Folder** at the bottom left. Type **Assistant** and click **Create**.
5. With the new **Assistant** folder selected, click **Open**.



Drawing. The folder choice, under the message box.



Drawing. Make the folder, then click Open.

You'll know it worked when the folder choice under the message box now says **Assistant**.

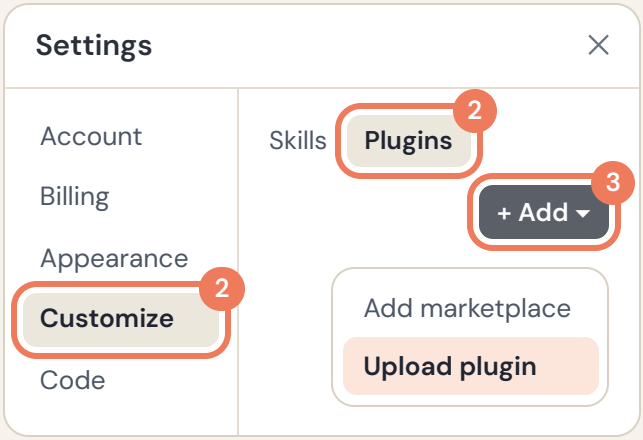
Not in Documents, Desktop or Downloads. Your Mac guards those three and can block Claude from them ("Couldn't access Documents"). Your home folder has no such guard. You'll come back to this same folder every time you open the Assistant.

STEP 3 OF 5 · ABOUT 2 MINUTES

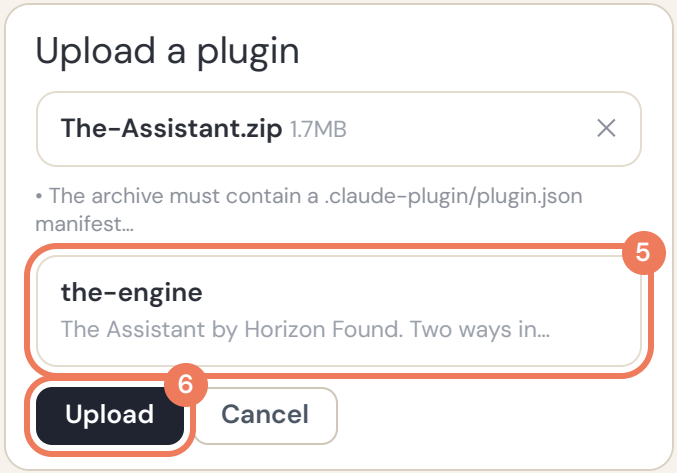
3 Add the Assistant to Claude

You add the Assistant from Claude's own **Settings**, using the file we sent you. **Nothing gets typed or pasted.**

1. At the bottom left of the Claude window, click the **gear** next to your name. **Settings** opens.
2. In the list on the left, click **Customize**. Then click **Plugins** at the top.
3. Click **+ Add** at the top right, then **Upload plugin**.
4. Choose **The-Assistant.zip** from your Downloads folder.
5. Look at the **Preview** box. It should say **the-engine** and "The Assistant by Horizon Found..." (the-engine is the Assistant's behind-the-scenes name.)
6. Click the black **Upload** button. Then close Settings with the **X**.



Drawing. Settings, then Customize, Plugins, + Add.



Drawing. The grey line under the file is always there. It is not an error.

You'll know it worked when there is **no red box**, the Preview shows the Assistant, and Upload goes through.

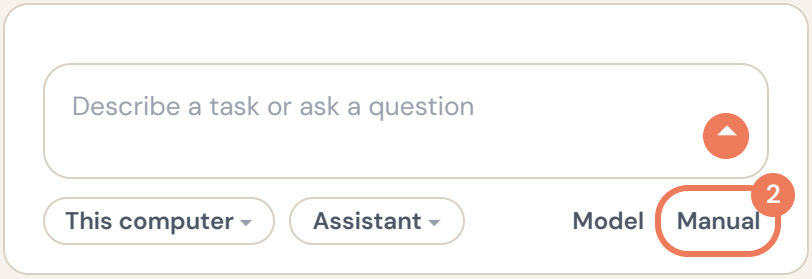
A red box that says "failed validation"? Stop and send us a screenshot. That one is ours to fix. **Had "The Engine" before?** Remove it first: in Plugins, click **Yours**, find The Engine, and uninstall it. **Don't use "Add marketplace"** or add "The Engine" from Discover: that is an old copy.

STEP 4 OF 5 · ABOUT 30 SECONDS

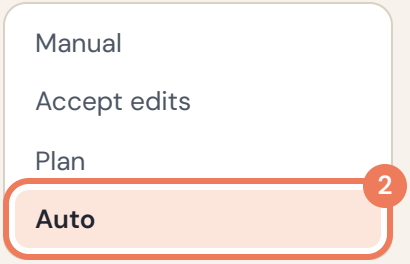
4 Let it work while you're away

This is the step that makes "walk away" true. Without it, Claude stops every few seconds to ask "may I do this?", and a backup can't finish while you're out of the room.

1. Look at the row under the message box, on the right. If it already says **Auto**, you're done with this step.
2. If it says **Manual**, click that word. In the list that opens, click **Auto**.



Drawing. The word is on the right, under the message box.



Drawing. Then click Auto.

You'll know it worked when that word now says **Auto**. Claude remembers it for your Assistant folder.

Is this safe? Auto means Claude does the backup's steps without asking each time, with its own safety checks running. And the Assistant has its own rule that nothing may break, in any mode: **nothing on your memory card is ever deleted, moved or changed.**

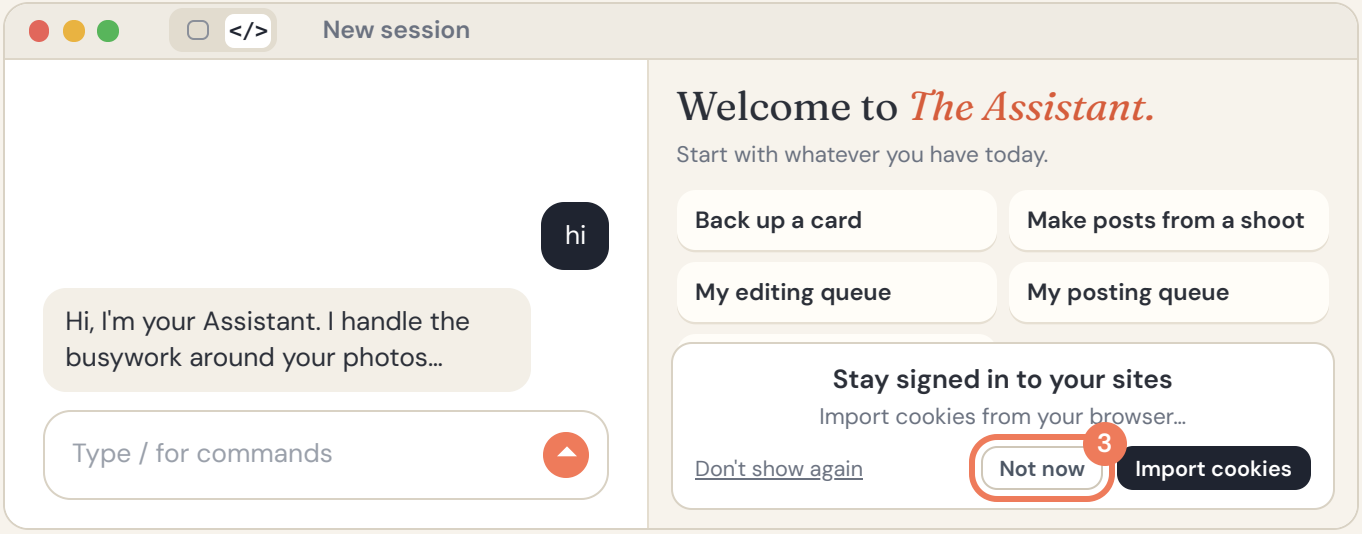
Don't see Auto in the list? In the same row, click the model's name and pick the newest Claude model. Then look again.

STEP 5 OF 5 · YOU'RE THERE

5 Say hi

That's the setup. Now meet your Assistant.

1. Click inside the message box, type **hi** and press **Return**.
2. Give it about twenty seconds. The Assistant introduces itself, and its home page opens beside the chat.
3. Claude may ask to **import cookies** from your browser ("Stay signed in to your sites"). Click **Not now**, or **Don't show again**. The Assistant doesn't need them.



Drawing. The chat on the left, the Assistant's home page on the right, and the pop-up to dismiss.

Three things your Mac might ask, once each

"Claude would like to access files on a removable volume"	Click **Allow**. That is your memory card or your photo drive. It comes up the first time the Assistant reads one.
A window from Apple about "command line developer tools"	Click **Install**, then **Agree**. Wait five to ten minutes, then type **done** in Claude. It's one free piece from Apple the Assistant runs on.
"Couldn't access Documents"	Your Assistant folder is inside Documents. Go back to Step 2 and make it in your home folder.

You're set up. From now on, opening the Assistant is: open Claude, click the **</>** picture, start a new session in your **Assistant** folder, say **hi**.

YOU'RE IN

Two good places to *start*

You don't need a memory card to begin. Start with whatever you have today. You talk to the Assistant in your own words, the way you'd talk to a person.

Photos you've *already finished*

Edited and exported, sitting in a folder.

1. On the home page, click **Make posts from a shoot**.
2. Follow the box that opens. The first time, it has you paste **set up my Assistant folder**.
3. Click **Select the folder with your finished photos** and pick your exports.
4. Paste **make my posts** in the chat.

You get single posts, a carousel, stories and a reel, with captions written from what you tell it. Your originals aren't moved or changed.

A *memory card* with new photos

Straight out of the camera.

1. Put the card in and plug in your drive.
2. Type **backup now** in the chat.
3. The first time only, it asks a few quick questions with buttons.
4. When it says **You can walk away**, walk away.

When you're back, click **Show the report** in the chat. Every photo is copied and checked, sorted into named shoots, with six sneak peeks picked to edit first.

If something isn't right

The page beside the chat is blank, or shows a play button	Don't press the play button. Type **show the Assistant** and the page comes back.
Claude keeps asking "may I run this?"	Step 4 slipped back. In the row under the message box, change **Manual** to **Auto**.
"Couldn't access Documents"	Make the Assistant's folder in your home folder, not in Documents. See Step 2.
A backup stopped	The Assistant says why, first thing, in plain words. Fix that (plug the drive in, clear space) and say **backup now** again. Nothing is copied twice.
We tell you there's an update	We'll send a new file and the steps with it.
You're not sure what to do next	Say **hi**. It tells you where things stand and what you can say.

Three promises: nothing on your memory card is ever changed. Nothing is ever deleted. Nothing is ever posted or sent for you.